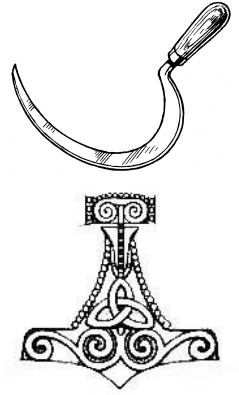


DER GMEESCHAFTSEGE BEIM SCHABERNACK-SEATTLE 3. YUULING, 2016



ROBERT LUSCH (MIT DENKI ZUM BRIAN WEIS)

REV - D 7

Honoring: Weisskeppichi, Berchta, Waahra

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune intoned thrice: Laguz, Kenaz, Dagaz, Tiwaz

Die Heiliching - The Hallowing

*Sichel un Schpiggel, weiht daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Beschitzt uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe,
Bei Wudan un Freid fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeit un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde
Bei Frey un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu schneide un sammle
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtiche.
Bei der Weisskeppiche Fraa un der Fraa Berchta un fer es Volk zu erneire
Wie schmittet der Hammer die Sichel,
So die Sichel der Hammer fiedert.
'S iss es Lewesraad, zu saehe un zu schneide
Sichel un Schpiggel, weiht daer Aldaar un die Schtell*

Heel!

Heel!

Heel!

Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

Heit sammle mir uns do, fer die Haerrin Berchta, die Weisskeppich Fraa, un die Waahra zu ehre.

Heel zu de Ziewe!

Heel zu de Wichde!

Heel zum Land!

Heel zu der Gmeeschaft!

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

Invocations to Berchta, Weisskeppichi Fraa, and Waahra will be made both in Deutsch and in English.

*Berchta – Brechdi Fraa
Keenichin vun der Unnergegend
Der Dunkelhelft ihre Machthawwern
Schtell unsere Meind richdich
Un helf uns fer in uns selwert reizugucke
Kumm mol heit zu uns,
Un sei unser geehrdi Gaschtin!*

*Berchta – Bright Lady
Queen of the Unnergegend
Ruler of the Dark Half
Set our minds right
And help us to look into ourselves
Come to us today,
And be our honored Guest!*

*Weisskeppichi
Du fliesscht in der Megge darrich uns,
Belewend uns
Binnend uns
Heelend uns
Kumm mol heit zu uns,
Un sei unser geehrdi Gaschtin!*

*White-Haired Woman
You flow through is in the main
Enlivening us
Connecting us
Healing us
Come to us today,
And be our honored Guest!*

*Waahra – Waahrheitheerern
Edeli Zeigin
Heer heit unsere Eed
Un hald uns zu unserem Ehrewatt fescht
Kumm mol heit zu uns,
Un sei unser geehrdi Gaschtin!
Heele!*

*Waahra – Truth-Hearer
Noble Witness
Hear our oaths today
And hold us fast to our words of honor
Come to us today,
And be our honored Guest!
Hail!*

Es Opfer un Die Eed - The Offering and the Oaths

Losst uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar yetz schtelle.

Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz voraa.

If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar.

If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.

Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - The Hallowing of the Offerings

Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

Der Sege - The Blessing

When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):

*Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns
Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Ziewe*

*From the gods to the Earth to us
From us to the Earth to the gods*

*'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk
Heele!*

*A gift for a gift.
Hail!*

Zum Schluss - In Closing

Zu de Wichde - To the Wights

Topics for Discussion

BERCHTA

Goddess most likely of the *Wane*. She is seen either as a sister to Holle or as Holle by another name. Her holiday is 31. Yuuling (December) on the current calendar. As is the case with many Teutonic goddesses, She is known for spinning. In the post-Heathen era, Her honor has been tainted by the Church, though the horrid masks that appear as depictions of the Wild Hunt in parts of Germany and Switzerland carry both a fear and a respect for the powerful goddess.

She seeks order in our lives, particularly lucidity of thought. This is, perhaps, akin to this time of introspection and the forming of New Year's Resolutions.

She has a definite "dark" angle to Her, but buried within this aspect is a reflection of the dark side within each of us. We observed, recognized, and even embraced these aspects of ourselves during the time of Belsnickel and Krampus prior to Yule. There is also value in assessing this side of us now we work on improving ourselves in the coming year.

The Berchtaslaaf, or the Progression of Berchta is a feast that includes gruel and fish, which is Berchta's prescribed meal. Urglaawer typically make the fare to consist of herring and oatmeal or dumpling and herring meal (Grimm, *Teutonic* 273). Some folks, particularly our Frankish brethren in Canada, also make Zemmede (also known as Zemmete, Semmede, and a few other variations) as part of Berchta's meal. Zemmede turn up in a number of practices among the Deitsch, too, and we include them in our Twelfth Night observances.

The owl is sacred to Berchta and is known for its wisdom. Historically, among the Christian Deitsch, there was a malediction towards the depiction of owls in drawing or in print, and they were often associated with witches (a connection to Berchta) and cast in a negative light. In the continuing paranoia of witches, owl carcasses were also nailed to the sides of sheds or barns in an attempt to frighten off other owls or to protect against evil spirits. Practitioners of Braucherei, however, never bought into this taboo against this "heathen" practice.

Mirrors also have an association with Berchta, but the origins of this association are not fully clear. The Braucherei community has speculated that the root may be in healing sessions that call to Berchta for aid in mental challenges and illnesses, which often also involve the client engaging in efforts to understand him/herself. Additionally, the seasonal focus for the time between Allelieweziel and the end of Yuul is Selbschtreiguck, which is the ancillary virtue of Introspection. The final night of Yule also being Berchta's feast day may also, therefore, play a role in the mirror being associated with Berchta.

Another reason for the connection drawn between Berchta and mirrors may be the general association of mirrors with wisdom and luck. There are several references in Deitsch lore to mirrors, particularly an Erdschpiggel ("Earth mirror") being used to find treasure, but another dot connecting mirrors with wisdom comes in the obverse form of our trickster character, Till Eileschpiggel ("owl mirror"), who represents the reflection of wisdom (buffoonery) in his actions.

The most intact tale we have related to Berchta is the closing of the Wonenacht myth, which describes Her as Holle's "sister," describes Berchta's role in the Wild Hunt as being within this realm, and Her taking souls from Holle's Mill to her own home in the Unnergegend.

WEISSKEPPICHI FRAA

die Weisskeppich Fraa, also known as Weisskeppichi Fraa: White-Haired Woman. An Urglaawe goddess known uniquely through Braucherei. She is referred to as the first practitioner of Braucherei (Tobin, Powwow Birds 7) and is sometimes compared to the Norse Eir.

Descriptions of this goddess allow for a link between Her and the White Ladies (Grimm, pp. 962-968). Some theories propose that Weisskeppichi Fraa is Berchta. These theories emerge from the fact that the Goldeneil, or golden owl, is sacred to Her (Tobin, *Powwow Birds* 7) and the owl is sacred to Berchta, and also because Berchta's name means "white" (Grimm, 968).

However, there is insufficient supporting evidence for this claim. Weisskeppichi Fraa frequently appears alongside Holle, thus negating theories that Holle and She are one and the same. Therefore, Die Weisskeppich Fraa is, most likely, a White Lady whose name either is lost to time or is awaiting our discovery within the Braucher interviews that still need to be catalogued.

Die Weisskeppich Fraa is known to be the paramount of healing -- physically, mentally, and spiritually.

Tobin, Jesse. "Powwow Birds." *Hollerbeier Haven: Journal of Traditional Deutsch Wisdom*, vol. 1 no. 3, p. 7. Kempton, PA: Three Sisters Center for the Healing Arts, November 2007.

Grimm, Jacob, James Stallybrass, trans. *Teutonic Mythology* (4 vols). New York: Dover Publications, 1966.

WAAHRA

die Waahr, die Waahra: Goddess known as Vár from sources, including the Prymskviða, or Thrym's Poem in the Poetic Edda (Larrington 101). In Urglaawe, She witnesses oaths, contracts, and vows, including marital vows.

Die Aarufing

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun der Nadde, vun der Erd, vun em Schtee

Mit der Ruhzeit im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit Erdgraft sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Naddwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun em Oscht, vun der Luft, un em Sunnuff

Mit Yungezeit im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit Luftgraft sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Oschtwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun der Sudde, vun em Summer, un em Feier

mit Leidenschaft im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmliche mit Feier sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Suddwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun em Wescht, vun em Wasser, un Schpotyaahr

Mit Heemgehzeit im Hatz

Kummt doch her gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit em Wasser sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Weschtwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu de mitleidiche Graft vun em Himmel, vun em Schepfer, vun em Schtanne

Mit der Umwandleheet im Hatz

Kumm doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit em Himmel sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Himmelwind in uns!

Ich ruf die mitleidiche Graft hie vun unich der Erd, der Geischthieling

Mit Freindschaft im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit de Voreldere sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich es Gebliet in uns!

The Invocation

I call upon the compassionate powers of the north, of the earth, of the stone with the time of rest in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of earth.

The dear gods and goddesses through the northwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the east of the air, of the sunrise with the time of youth in heart.

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of air.

The dear gods and goddesses through the eastwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the south, of the summer, and the fire, with passion in Heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of fire.

The dear gods and goddesses through the southwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the west, of the water, and autumn, with the return to home in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of water.

The dear gods and goddesses through the westwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the heavens, of the creator, of the stars, transformation in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of the heavens.

The dear gods and goddesses through the heavenwind in us.

I call the compassionate powers here from under the earth, the spiritcave (dwelling of the ancestral spirits), with our lineage (vorbearers, ancestors) in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the ancestors.

The dear gods and goddesses through the blood (family) in us.

Hail!